Unit 2: Technology

could/couldn't and had to/didn't have to

Lesson 2-2
Book pages 43-45

💡 **Big idea:** **could/couldn't** is the past of **can/can't**. **had to/didn't have to** is the past of **have to/don't have to**. In the past, children **couldn't** use computers and **had to** write with a pen.

🎯 **I will learn:**

- Read the Team Talk about Arlo's homework
- Talk about ability in the past with could and couldn't
- Talk about what was necessary in the past with had to and didn't have to

📖 Key words

forget ينسى	**stop working** يتوقف عن العمل	**ability** قدرة	**necessary** ضروري
in the past في الماضي	**letter** رسالة ورقية	**send** يرسل	

Team Talk: Arlo's homework

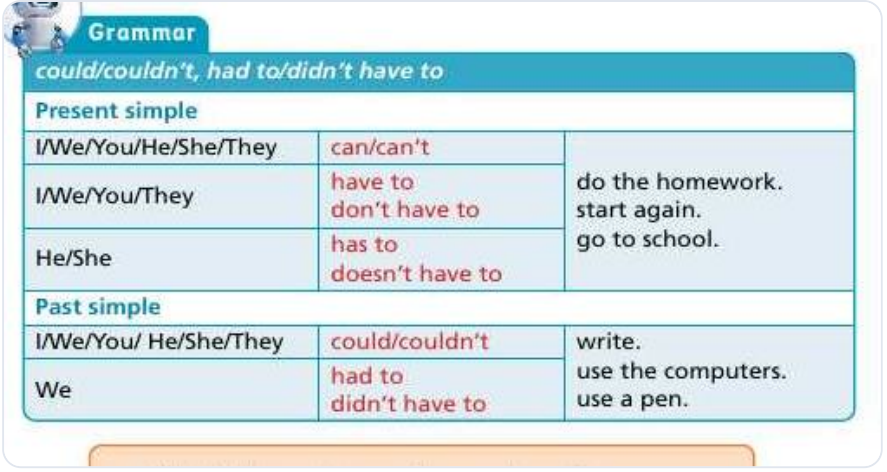
- Arlo didn't send his Maths homework because his **laptop stopped working**
- He **had to** use his brother's computer, but the Wi-Fi didn't work
- He has to give it to the teacher today
- Sultan gives him a **pen and some paper**
- Expressions: **Why not?**
- **Oh, dear!**
- **You're joking!**

can → could

- Present: I **can / can't** write
- Past: He **could** write when he was five
- Past: In the past, children **couldn't** use computers
- could + verb (no -s, no -ed)

have to → had to

- Present: I **have to / don't have to** do my homework
- He **has to / doesn't have to** go to school
- Past: He **had to** use his brother's computer
- Past: They **didn't have to** do it three times



Grammar

could/couldn't, had to/didn't have to		
Present simple		
I/We/You/He/She/They	can/can't	do the homework. start again. go to school.
I/We/You/They	have to don't have to	
He/She	has to doesn't have to	
Past simple		
I/We/You/ He/She/They	could/couldn't	write. use the computers. use a pen.
We	had to didn't have to	

Grammar: could/couldn't, had to/didn't have to

✏️ Examples

In the past, people ___ send emails.

Answer: In the past, people couldn't send emails.

They ___ write letters. (necessary in the past)

Answer: They had to write letters.

⭐ Remember

- Past of can = **could**
- Past of have to = **had to**
- Negative = **couldn't / didn't have to**

⚠️ Watch out

- He could wrote ✗ → He could **write** ✓
- He didn't had to ✗ → He didn't **have to** ✓

🧩 **Activity:** Compare the past and now: write what people couldn't do and what they had to do before technology

✅ Check yourself

1. What is the past of can?
2. What is the past of have to?
3. Why didn't Arlo send his homework?

Answers: (1) could ، (2) had to ، (3) His laptop stopped working